

War and British Society c.790 to c.2010 (J410/10)

This British thematic study focuses on the relationship between war and society over a long period of British history, c.790 to c.2010. This includes a broad sweep of time which covers the impact of different types of warfare (including defence from invasion, conquest and civil war).

Covering 1000 years, the thematic study is a different type of historical practice from the depth studies and even the period Study. The broad sweep of time covered by the unit precludes the listing of specific events in the manner of other parts of the specification.

Therefore, the study is divided into three eras and these eras are divided into broad sections. The eras and sections have been chosen as vehicles through which learners can investigate a number of key themes.

- The impacts of different types of war – the study covers wars of defence, wars of conquest, wars of religion and civil wars, providing

opportunities to consider whether different types of wars have different impacts.

- Attitudes and responses to war – the sections in the study are designed to examine the ways in which civilians and military personnel react to different wars and how this might change in the course of a war.
- Impacts of war on people – the different conflicts covered in the study have been chosen to illustrate the different ways in which wars impact on populations, both military and civilian (or in the earlier in the periods, the aristocracy where military or civilian status was blurred).
- Impacts of war on the relationship between governments and people – the range of conflicts here demonstrates some of the ways in which wars can unite and also divide people and their governments.

Key Topics	Content Learners should have studied the following:
c.790–c.1500 Themes: • Different types of war • Attitudes and responses to war • Impacts of war on people • Impacts of war on government and politics	Viking raids on Anglo-Saxon England 790–1066: impact of the raids; responses to the raids. The Norman Conquest: English resistance; the establishment of Norman control under William I; the establishment of the Feudal system; the extent of the impact of the changes introduced by the Normans on different levels of society. Feudal society c.1100–1215: feudal relationship between monarchs and barons; breakdowns in the relationship under Stephen 1135–1154 and John 1214–1216. Significance of war in medieval society c.1290–c.1450: changing nature of war and its effects; development and adaptation of feudal service; financial cost of war; impact on populations where armies fought or were stationed.
c.1500–c.1750 Themes: • Different types of war • Attitudes and responses to war • Impacts of war on people • Impacts of war on government and politics	Elizabeth I's wars with Spain in Europe and in the new world, their impact on the prestige and power of the monarch and relations with Parliament; the actions of English privateers, including their impact on the security, economy and the people of England. Warfare on the English-Scottish borders and its impact on border society c.1500–c.1600. The Civil Wars of 1642–1651 in England, Scotland and Ireland: the nature of these wars; their impact on the people of England, Scotland and Ireland. The Jacobite Wars 1715 and 1745: the impact on Scotland of the repression of the Jacobites.
c.1750–c.2010 Themes: • Different types of war • Attitudes and responses to war • Impacts of war on people • Impacts of war on government and politics	Imperial wars in the 18th and early 19th centuries: gains made in Seven Years War (1756–1763) and their effects on Britain. Wars against Revolutionary / Napoleonic France and subsequent effects on British society and politics. Imperial conflicts in the second half of the 19th century: effects of the Crimean War; Boer Wars 1880–1881 and 1899–1902. The First and Second World Wars: the beginnings of 'total war', including the impact on people's lives, increased state power and the changing relationship between the state and the people. Post-1945 conflicts - impacts and popular responses: Cold War and Britain in the 1950s and 1960s; IRA campaigns 1969–1994; the Iraq War 2003; terrorist threats and counter measures post-2003.